

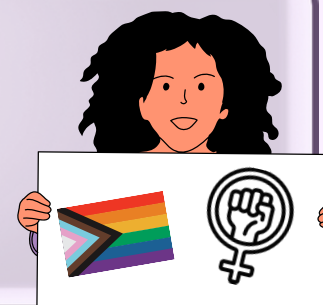
The **Intersectional** Trifecta: How Writing Studies Dismantles Power Structures

By Keith Hernandez



1

Gender



Within queer-focused readings, discussions, and pedagogy, there is emphasis in being provocative and edgy to purposefully destabilize the audience's definition of "normal" in gender and other related categories (DiGrazia and Boucher).

Examples



This is fundamental to produce discourse, which carries the possibilities of disruption and counter-discourses (Foucault). With that ability, students are capable of utilizing writing classrooms as a space for either the rebuilding or formation of identity categories and the reimagination of what's deemed possible for self-representation.

the family, the body, censorship, healthcare and reproductive politics, national affiliation and neo-imperialism

For second language learners, writers, and bilingualists, there are significant issues raised from its correlation to gender: its fixed view within the male-to-female dichotomy of learning and the asymmetrical power relations involved in that divergence (Kubota).

Examples



Despite fixed, static notions of gender difference, recent theorizations underline multiple and fluid identities, social and linguistic construction ("becoming" rather than "being"), individual agency, and gender as performative rather than essentialized categories of masculinity and femininity (Kubota). These perspectives combat the hierarchies of power produced, and reinforced through language use (Kubota).

motivation/investment, teacher perceptions, classroom interaction, and testing

2

Race



Due to the colonial encounters between Europeans, Africans, and indigenous peoples, scholars of settler colonialist discourse have depicted fear and violence toward any non-heteronormative sexualities, particularly with indigenous peoples that displayed any nonnormative expression of gender and sexuality (Tompkins).



Through applying methods of geopolitical disruption, the breaking of family networks, and disciplinary regimes, a framework was established in labeling indigenous peoples as "animalistic" and "feminine", thereby imposing heteronormative patriarchy catered to white European males as the sole "human" (Tompkins).

With African populations, various forms of racialized aggression had taken place, with examples ranging from chattel slavery to the reoccurring sex panics tied into later waves of immigration (Tompkins).

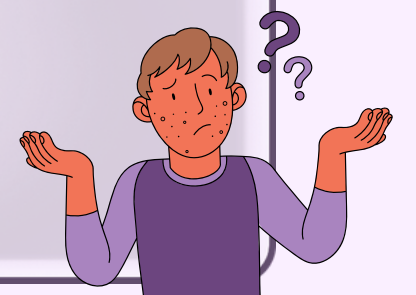
As a result, they were sanctioned and subjected to economic sexual violence underneath the guise of being "breedable stock" and "nonhuman inventory", making them lack adequate protections under the law.

Throughout U.S. history, this has been exemplified in legal, juridical, and disciplinary violence set against other racialized groups, shaping the experiences and perspectives translated in their bodies of work.

To identify as black, there was a framing of sexualization against white citizens and therefore always being portrayed as "deviant".

3

Sexuality



For sexuality-based studies, there is a concentration on evoking metrics of sexuality and identity beyond the traditional disciplinary boundaries that have become insufficient containers for the subjects whose lives and utterances far traverse the categories they're contained in (Ferguson).



Earlier critiques in racism and heterosexism unveil the failures of prior feminist scholarship to reflect on its own "white solipsism" and "compulsory heterosexuality" failing to account for the differences and definition behind what a "woman" that spawed in what is now known as identity politics (Daly).



Because the scholarships are primarily characterized for their diversity in context and common perspective, especially among marginalized groups such as gays and lesbians, they possess an "outsider within" perspective, raising many questions about the preconceived notions in many aspects of social reality (Weber).

Now that scholars are beginning to search for and conceptualize these kinds of studies, there will be greater opportunities for critique and debate, therefore furthering the development of these scholarships while providing an outline for teaching about this work in writing studies.

One common consensus is evident: the social constructions of Whiteness, masculinity, and heterosexuality play a major role in these scholarship with their linkage to oppressed groups.



4

Advocacy



For race, gender, and sexuality scholarship studies, maintaining these kinds of analyses in entirely understanding oppression and seeking social change and social justice by effectively understanding the marginalized groups experiences (Weber).

How Do Race, Gender, and Sexuality Intersect?



1

Liberation in Cultural Expression:

The importance behind literary contributions such as women of color feminism have demonstrated the difficulties in separating queer of color theory from queer of color cultural production into fiction, poetry, dance, film and other forms of creativity (Tompkins).

In contrast, works of multiracial feminism examine the historical and social possibilities and their connection to macro social structures and the power relations within them (Weber).

Counteracting these oppressive systems reliant on power imbalances, marginalized communities of race, gender, and sexuality upheld their cultural, familial, and emotional forms of expression that survived, testifying to the resistance against these hierarchal systems. In these social situations, they are able to simultaneously operate and look out for the collective goal of equitable opportunity and resources.



2

Socially Constructed:

In race, sexuality, and gender, each of their meanings are built out of their group struggles and how the dominant group defines these categories as opposites of each other (Weber).



Key Terms

Queer of Color Critique:

An intersectional and analytical framework that inspects the overlapping histories in how race, gender, sexuality, class and nation each intersect to form the lived experiences of queer people of color.

Sexed Bodies:

The lens in which the human body is viewed and categorized from in terms of sex, a concept often rooted in biological and social construction.

Class-Race Gender:

A multifaceted basis that serves beyond its three relations: they are notions that determine structures of inequality.

Doing Gender:

A description made by Candance West and David Zimmerman in 1987 that describes gender as a non-biological trait, instead being a performed aspect in everyday life for any kind of social situation.



3

Context-Specific:

Race, sexuality, and gender are each interconnected by their ability to never remain static or fixed, constantly undergoing reformation as part of new economic, political, and ideological processes, trends, and events (Weber).

This can especially be portrayed in its relationship to language, being categorized as a system of social relations that can acquire multiple relations and meanings (Kubota).

Example



The **post-Civil Rights era** with racial signifiers (Latino/a, Asian American) developed to recognize differences among racial ethnic groups.

5

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